

Informed Consent

This text will be presented in a digital format as a preamble to the online questionnaire. Participants will have to read and affirm consent before continuing to the questionnaire.

Name of the Study: Deriving insights for research data sharing from a large-scale data sharing initiative in Canada

Sponsor: Canadian Institutes of Health Research / Public Health Agency of Canada

Purpose: Health data sharing is widely understood as a technical challenge — one of interoperability, access infrastructure, and standardization. However, it also involves much organizational labour to negotiate agreements across institutions, align diverse stakeholders needs, and sustain collaborative relationships under conditions of uncertainty and urgency. These organizational dimensions have remained largely invisible in research on health data infrastructure, crowded out by a strong emphasis on technical solutions.

The goals of the study are to characterize these under-recognized dimensions of health data-sharing using the COVID-19 Immunity Task Force (CITF) Databank as a case study. Specifically, we aim to to characterize the coordination processes among the CITF Databank’s partners, core Databank personnel, and other related stakeholders, and to identify human and organizational determinants of observed coordination behaviours.

We invite you to participate in this study due to your involvement with the CITF Databank. Your engagement with this questionnaire regarding CITF Databank operations will help improve similar large-scale data-sharing initiatives that emerge from the CITF Databank model in the future.

Study Procedures: Your participation in this study will involve answering a short questionnaire, which should take around 30 minutes to complete. The questions will ask about your professional background, as well as your experiences, attitudes and behaviours relating to your participation in the CITF Databank initiative.

Voluntary Participation: Your participation in this study is voluntary. You may withdraw from the study for any reason prior to the start of analysis. If you decide to withdraw from the study, information generated because of your participation will be destroyed, unless you give permission to retain them.

Potential Risks: Your participation in this study does not involve any physical, psychological or legal risks. No personal information will be collected and there will be no association between your responses and your personal identity.

Benefits: This study contributes to the development of better epidemiological data-sharing infrastructures by articulating collaborative and operational aspects, which are generally under-recognized. Framing data-sharing as a social and collaborative activity enables us to devise more effective data-sharing infrastructures that more accurately reflect how science is done. This project will therefore help develop practical data-sharing solutions and policy frameworks that respond to researchers' actual needs and expectations. Additionally, this study may directly benefit you by encouraging reflection about your own research practices.

Compensation: You will not be compensated for participating in this study.

Confidentiality: No personal information will be collected and there will be no association between your responses and your personal identity. Your responses will be associated with the CITF-affiliated project that you identify as a member of, your specific role when working with the CITF Databank, your gender, and your institutional affiliation. Any identifying information that you include in open-ended responses will be redacted.

The study is committed to adhering to fundamental data security practices, including those specified in McGill University's Cloud Directive, which regulates the curation of sensitive research data. Digital records will be stored on encrypted and password-protected drives and on secure servers approved or managed by McGill University under the Cloud Directive. Physical records will be kept in a locked drawer at McGill University's School of Population and Global Health, which is a secure workspace. Data may be stored on servers outside Québec.

Dissemination of Results: The findings deriving from this study may be published in peer-reviewed journals, at conferences, and in media intended for lay-audiences (e.g. blogs, podcasts, social media). The findings may also serve as a source of evidence in policy briefs or recommendations to enhance the infrastructures and policy mandates that govern data-sharing practices.

Questions: Please contact the principal researcher, Zachary Batist, if you have any questions about the study, either by phone at (438) 507-8685 or by email at zachary.batist@mcgill.ca.

If you have any ethical concerns or complaints about your participation in this study and want to speak with someone not on the research team, please contact the Research Ethics Board Office, daniel.tesolin@mcgill.ca or 514-398-5410, citing REB file number 26-08-029.

Consent to Participate Statement: Please indicate that you have read the above information and consent to participate in this study. Agreeing to participate in this study does not waive any of your rights or release the researchers from their responsibilities. To ensure the study is being conducted properly, authorized individuals, such as a member of the Research Ethics Board, may have access to your information. A copy of this consent form will be given to you and the researcher

will keep a copy.

I agree to participate in the study:

☐ Yes

☐ No

Participant Name: _____

Date: _____

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